

Texas Doughnut

Oversized yeast-raised — Shipley's / Cambodian-shop lineage · tall, cottony-light crumb · thin crackle-set glaze

YIELD	FLOUR	HYDRATION	FRY
~10 @ 6" + holes	Sir Lancelot 14.2%	~58% eff.	350°F / 177°C

FORMULA — BAKER'S PERCENTAGES

Flour = 100% · scale to any flour weight

Bread flour — Sir Lancelot / Shepherd's Grain Opus (~14%); strength to tower the jumbo ring through proof	100%	1000 g
Whole milk — hydration + tenderness; hold a little back, add to feel	52%	520 g
Whole egg — 3 large; structure, lift, color	15%	150 g
Butter, softened — tender crumb, shelf life	12%	120 g
Granulated sugar — yeast food + Maillard browning	12%	120 g
Instant yeast — capped at 2%; more risks over-proof collapse at this size	2%	20 g
Kosher salt (by weight) — yeast regulation, flavor, gluten tightening	1.5%	15 g
Vanilla extract — flavor	1%	10 g

GLAZE

Crackle-set shellac

Powdered sugar	250 g
Whole milk	50 g
Light corn syrup / glucose	20 g
Vanilla to taste	—
Kosher salt pinch	—

Warm to ~40°C, dip warm doughnuts, drip on a rack. The corn syrup is what gives the thin translucent crackle-set shellac.

DOUGH READ

Drive the dough, not the gram count

Finish by feel: soft, smooth, slightly tacky — **not slack**. Effective hydration is ~58% once the egg's water is counted. **Hi-gluten flour drinks more water** than the standard bread flour this style is usually written for, so at 52% milk the dough may feel stiff — add the last of the milk (and a splash beyond if needed) to reach the soft-tacky finish. An enriched dough must be **fully developed** or it won't tower.

Execution

OIL	ROLL	FRY	BATCH
350°F / 177°C	½" (¾" taller)	~90 s / side	2–3 max

MIX · BULK · CUT

- Mix:** combine dries (flour, sugar, kosher salt, instant yeast) + egg, milk, vanilla → shaggy mass.
- Knead to near-windowpane BEFORE the butter.** The structure has to be there first.
- Add softened butter;** knead to smooth, elastic, slightly tacky. Finish by feel — hi-gluten flour may want a splash more milk.
- Bulk ferment** to doubled, ~1–1.5 h at room temp. **Or cold-retard overnight** — deeper flavor, firmer dough, cleaner cuts.
- Sheet** cold dough to ½" (¾" for more height).
- Cut 6" outer / 1.5" hole. Do NOT twist the cutter** — sealed edges won't rise.
- Transfer each ring to its own 6×6" parchment square.** The paper is the transfer tool.

PROOF · FRY · GLAZE

- Final proof, 45–60 min,** covered loosely. Done when puffy and light, and a gentle poke holds a **slow-filling** indent — it should not spring fully back.
- Heat oil** (canola / peanut / shortening) to **350°F / 177°C**. Deep pot, half-full max; clip a thermometer.
- Lower each doughnut on its parchment, proof-side down.** After ~5–10 s the paper releases — pull it with tongs and discard.
- Fry to deep golden, ONE flip:** ~90 s/side at ½" (~2 min/side at ¾"). **Watch the white equator belt, not the clock.**
- Drain** on a wire rack over a sheet. **Glaze warm** (formula, page 1).

Time = thickness, not diameter. A 6" ring and a 3" ring at the same thickness fry in the same window — the oil drives heat through the same ½" either way. Set time by how thick you rolled.

FRY & FIX

Fry by observation — root cause → correction

Oil temp drifts	Clip a thermometer, check every batch . Below 350°F → greasy; above ~365°F → outside darkens before the center cooks. Hold 350°F and let it recover between drops.
Greasy / oil-logged	Oil too cold or sagged between batches, or over-proofed (weak structure soaks oil). Hold 350°F; 2–3 doughnuts max so temp recovers.
Raw center, dark crust	Oil too hot. Drop the temp.
No white belt	Flipped more than once, oil too cold, or under-proofed. Flip ONCE at golden — color, not clock.
Dense, tight crumb	Under-proofed, or gluten under-developed. Proof to a slow-filling poke; develop to near-windowpane before the butter.
Collapsed after proof	Over-proofed — too much gas for the gluten to hold. The poke should fill back slowly , not vanish.
Glaze weeps / runs off	Doughnut too hot when glazed, or dough over-hydrated. Cool slightly before dipping.